



buzz



Jeeves is back

Ask, the search engine, is moving back to its previous name Ask Jeeves and has given the virtual butler a makeover.

To Wait or Watch: in HD

Many people opted for Direct-to-home (DTH) services when they were launched. But what is the next step for these services? Are there going to be any technological advances? These questions have been answered by Sun Direct service as it has recently launched its new High Definition (HD) DTH service.



Tony D'Silva, COO, Sun Direct, said that the new HD service will bring more realistic and breathtaking entertainment to people's homes. Sun Direct had reached a milestone that it had set, and had crossed 3.1 million subscribers. This was accomplished in a short period, compared to other similar services. The company therefore wanted to be the first to launch a service using this new HD technology. This step has also been taken after 1.5 million LCD TVs were sold last year and the expectation that this number will double this year, bringing a greater demand for higher quality content.

However, there are two major problems here – content and price. The content currently is very limited as there are only two channels, Tamil and Telugu movie channels, that offer HD content. The price of this HD box from Sun Direct costs approximately Rs. 10,000. So you really need to think whether you want to subscribe to such a service that has such limited content or wait until HD has become more mainstream. According to D'Silva, there are already more than 100 subscribers for this new HD service. So we guess there must be a lot of rich kids that can't wait to get their hands on this.

3G Delayed

The most talked about mobile technology these days is 3G. MTNL had announced it would launch 3G services soon, but this is not happening just yet. The launch is now supposed to be scheduled sometime in May. Jadoo, as the service is called, was supposed to have launched in February, but the response to this service in Delhi was nothing to boast about and this could have caused the delay in Mumbai.

MTNL has decided to move towards a new marketing strategy and will wait for a better 3G response before it goes ahead with the schedule. This brings up the question of whether the service will actually launch in May, as how much more could be actually considered as a better

response. Jadoo has a capacity to support about 1,50,000 subscribers, but currently there are only about 500 subscribers in the capital.

The plan is such that you have to pay Rs. 500 for activation and a monthly subscription charge of Rs. 599. Each call to a local MTNL number would cost 60 paise and Re. 1 to other operators. With 3G, video calls cost Rs. 1.80 within the MTNL network, while Rs. 3 for other networks.

Cricket: On the Go

The DLF Indian Premier League (IPL) has hit us again with the second season being played in South Africa. Controversies aside, there's finally some good news – you can now watch live coverage over the internet. If you were on the move, the only way previously that you could remotely follow the match was through the radio or score updates via SMS. But things are going to change now and you will soon be able to get ball-by-ball updates on your mobile phone. This service is not going to be limited only to those who own phones that have 3G capabilities, but will also be available for 2G phones as well.

To get ball-by-ball updates, all you need to do is download the application from zengaentertainment.com. You will also need a GPRS connection to access this service. Some operators levy a monthly GPRS charge, while with others you will have a pay-as-you-use scheme, which may turn out to be costly. However, if you want such a live feed, then this is the best way to go.

Scientists + CO2 = Biofuel

Scientists from the Institute of Bioengineering and Nanotechnology, Singapore have found a way to convert CO2 into Methanol. They managed to do so by using the organocatalyst, N-heterocyclic carbenes (NHCs) in a reaction with carbon dioxide. The reaction is supposed to be stable under mild conditions in dry air. Adding to this, NHCs are easily available and only a little was used in the above reaction.

This is considered a big step that should help the environment. Some believe that this reaction still has flaws, even though the catalyst is abundantly available, the NHC decays very rapidly. Some also say this whole process is more

of a negative energy process, in which you use up more energy to create the methanol as compared to the amount of methanol produced.

In our books, this is definitely a good start as people have moved away from just the ideation phase and entered into the proving and performing phase.

Operation desert clone

Camel racing is popular in the Gulf region. So what does the Dubai Camel Reproduction Center do? It just cloned the first ever camel and have named her Injaz, which means Achievement. You must be wondering what's the link between camel racing and cloning, well since this has been successful, the Camel Reproduction Center plans on using this technique to clone some of the best racing camels so that they can keep their blood line going for years. Not only do they want the genes of the elite racing camels to be preserved and reproduced for future use, but also for their milk producing camels.



Injaz the first cloned camel in Dubai

The technique used by the scientists was the same as that used to clone Dolly the sheep in 1996; she was put down as she was diagnosed with lung cancer in 2003. Injaz is actually a clone of a camel that was slaughtered for its meat back in 2005. First the ovaries were removed and DNA was extracted from them. Next, the DNA was placed in the egg extracted from a surrogate mother. This egg is then planted back into the surrogate mother. Once Injaz was born, the tests showed that the DNA from Injaz matched that of the dead camel rather than the mother. Injaz was born after a 378-day gestation period and weighed 30 kg.

Brain invasion

Twitter, the microblogging, social networking web site has drawn a lot of attention of late. The first big achievement was thanks to celebrity Ashton Kutcher – he became the first user to have 1 million followers. The current